

Review questions

Unit 2 – Chapter 7

Self: Personality

The following chapter review consists of multiple choice, short answer, fill in the blanks, matching and labelling questions. Check your answers on the last page.

- 1 Personality means the characteristic ways of:
 - a thinking, speaking, knowing.
 - b thinking, feeling, acting.
 - c acting, growing, laughing.
 - d feeling, growing, acting.

- 2 Define personality and describe three ways researchers have tried to explain personality.

- 3 Match each term with its correct definition.

Personality	The internal regulator, which sets the standards for behaviour
Melancholic	The voice of conscience that focuses on how we ought to behave
Mesomorph	Depressed, sad and brooding
Id	The characteristic ways of thinking, feeling and acting that make a person an individual
Ego	The primitive part of our make-up that is made up of the urges for food, shelter and sexual gratification
Superego	Medium weight, strong and muscular

- 4 Freud thought that many adult personality traits are due to _____ in a stage. It is an emotional 'hang-up' caused by the person being frustrated or over-indulged.
- a fixation
 - b stimulation
 - c aggressive
 - d dependence

- 5 _____ is a technique which is aimed at investigating the unconscious motives of humans and tries to show harmless thoughts and emotions have an underlying sexual motive.
- a behaviour therapy
 - b cognitive therapy
 - c psychoanalysis
 - d holistic therapy

- 6 Define what is meant by the term 'personality traits' and describe three major trait theories which have contributed to the understanding of personality?

- 7 According to the trait dimensions outlined by the Eysenck (1963), a person who scored high on _____ is likely to be anxious, thoughtful and calm.
- a introversion
 - b extroversion
 - c competitiveness
 - d liberalism
- 8 According to Allport, traits that are regarded as basic building blocks for personality development are known as:
- a secondary traits.
 - b source traits.
 - c central traits.
 - d cardinal traits.

9 Humanistic theories focus on _____ personalities and believe people grow psychologically from _____ and are motivated to do so.

10 Outline Maslow's hierarchy of needs.

11 The Rorschach inkblot test is an example of a:

- a self-report inventory.
- b trait theory of personality.
- c thematic apperception test.
- d projective test.

12 Projective tests ask people to describe _____ to try to uncover their personalities through their descriptions and interpretations.

- a clothing
- b behavior
- c ambiguous stimuli
- d alphabet letters

13 Describe the TAT projective test.

- 14 MMPI stands for:
- a Minnesota Memory Personality Inventory.
 - b Minnesota Multiphasic Personality Inquiry.
 - c Minnesota Multiphasic Personality Inventory.
 - d Minnesota Multiple Personality Inventory.
- 15 The measurement of personality has found most use in:
- a organizational psychology.
 - b forensic psychology.
 - c educational psychology.
 - d clinical psychology.

Review questions answers

1 B

2 Definition of personality and explanations

Definition	Explanations	Marks
Personality	Personality is made up of the characteristic patterns of thoughts, feelings, and behaviours that make a person unique It arises from within the individual and remains fairly consistent and stable throughout life and across situations. Personality defines an individual, now, in the past when younger and into the future when older.	2
Personality determined by four fluids – Hippocrates	Classified people as being: • melancholic – depressed, sad and brooding if they had too much black bile • choleric – irritable, short-tempered and excitable if they had too much yellow bile • phlegmatic – slow and lethargic if they had too much phlegm • sanguine – cheerful, active and hopeful if they had lots of blood.	4
Body shape and personality – William Sheldon (1940)	Three body types linked to personality: • endomorph - the large, overweight type as being cheerful, relaxed and sociable. • mesomorphic - the athletic mesomorph was seen as being assertive, vigorous and courageous. • ectomorphic - the thin, scrawny was described as being introverted, intense and artistic.	4
Psychodynamic theory of personality – Freud (1856-1939)	Freud considered that personality develops from our efforts to resolve the conflict	4

	between our primitive, pleasure-seeking, biological urges and our internalised, socialised reactions to these. He saw this conflict as involving the interactions of three systems: the id, ego and superego.	
	Total	14

3 Match each term with its correct definition.

Personality	The characteristic ways of thinking, feeling and acting that make a person an individual.
Melancholic	Depressed, sad and brooding
Mesomorph	Medium weight, strong, muscular; assertive, vigorous and courageous
Id	The primitive part of our make-up that is made up of the urges for food, shelter and sexual gratification.
Ego	The internal regulator, which sets the standards for behaviour.
Superego	The voice of conscience that focuses on how we ought to behave.

4 A

5 C

6

Definition		Marks
Personality traits	- Personality traits describe the stable forms of behaviour that people display in any and every situation. - Traits are inferred from behaviour, and you expect people to behave in similar ways in different circumstances. - Traits can be used to predict future behaviour. - Can have cardinal traits (core traits), central traits (building blocks for personality development) and source traits (underlying personality traits) - Traits or personality types are only as good as the instruments developed to measure them.	3
Trait Theorists		
Gordon Allport (1897-1967)	Introduced the concept of traits as a generalised 'neuropsychic' systems or structures that could make environmental	4

	stimuli similar and that could initiate and guide consistency in behaviour. • These individual differences are learned by experience but represent consistencies in our behaviours. • They are sometimes called dispositions or traits to reflect the uniqueness in the ways individuals produce equivalences and consistencies between beliefs, feelings and actions. • Dispositions or traits vary from person to person. • Allport emphasising the uniqueness of everyone's consistency of personality • He also recognised that there may be common traits within a culture • These traits include extraversion, introversion, competitiveness and liberalism.	
Raymond Cattell (1905-1998)	• Refer to underlying personality traits, which are to be distinguished from surface traits (the visible display of personality). • Cattell identified 16 of these traits through factor analysis, a statistical method used to describe variability among observed, correlated variables in terms of a potentially • Smaller number of unobserved, underlying variables called factors. • The main difference between source traits and central traits is that Cattell derived source traits through a statistical technique known as factor analysis.	4
Hans Eysenck (1916-1997)	• Came up with two main personality factors: extraversion–introversion and emotional stability–instability. • By measuring these and looking at how people scored on these two factors, you could describe their personality. A person who was high on extraversion and stability would be carefree and show leadership, whereas one who was high on extraversion but unstable would be likely to be restless and aggressive. • He combined clinical psychology with experimental psychology to determine	4

	personality types based on the presence or absence of certain characteristics. • He developed the dimensions of neuroticism–emotional stability and extraversion–introversion. • Neuroticism refers to emotional instability and a tendency to be restless and anxious, whereas emotional stability refers to calmness and a relaxed manner. • Extraversion describes individuals who are active and outgoing • Introversion describes those who are more passive and calm, seek lower levels of stimulation and are characterised by being so traumatised by any displays of extravagant or uncharacteristic behaviour that they withdraw socially. • Another dimension, psychoticism, was added in the 1970s and was described by Eysenck as recklessness or disregard for common sense.	
	Total	15

7 A

8 C

9 Humanistic theories focus on **healthy** personalities and believe people grow psychologically from **within** and are motivated to do so.

10 Maslow's hierarchy of needs

Definition	Description	Marks
Abraham Maslow (1908-1970) Humanistic theorist	Maslow considered that we all have a hierarchy of needs and we must first have our most basic needs for food, water, sex and shelter met before we will try to meet higher-level needs. Once lower-level needs are met, we try to satisfy increasingly higher-level needs. Gratification of each need is required before moving upwards to the next levels There are five levels of needs in the hierarchy. At the base are physiological needs, which are those of food, water, warmth and sleep. The next basic need is safety – we need to make sure we are safe and secure. The intermediary needs are belongingness and love needs, characterised by the establishment of friendships and then of intimate relationships esteem needs, which are those needs that are achieved through accomplishment and recognition of success Finally, self-actualisation needs are those achieved when a person reaches self-fulfilment, the full use of one's talents, capacities and potential.	5
	Total	5

11 D

12 C

13 Describe the TAT projective test.

Term	Description	Marks
TAT - Thematic Apperception Test It is a projective test that was developed by Henry Murray in the 1930s.	It consists of 30 drawings showing scenes and life situations The person taking the test is shown about 10 of these drawings, depending on their age and gender. The client is then asked to make up a story about each picture, talking about what led up to the scene in the picture, what the characters are thinking or feeling and what will happen. The TAT is scored on the basis of the content of the story and the way it is told. The psychologist assumes that the person telling the story will reveal the conflicts or themes that are important to him or her and that underlie the individual's personality.	5
	Total	5

14 C**15 B**